What would make a first SIP still active at month 12?

North Star: increase the percentage of first-time mutual fund investors who still have an active SIP 12 months after starting their first one.

“Active” = at least one successful SIP instalment in the preceding 30 days. One investor counts once.

1 · Define	2 · Observe	3 · Contrast	4 · Decide	5 · Test
People, not plans	Intent, event, outcome	Repair, pause, continue	Reversible problem bet	Task, harm, next due

Product principle: a wanted, affordable contribution should work; an informed pause is also a valid investor outcome.

Decision today: study unwanted repair after a routine breaks. Reach, root cause and month-12 lift are still unmeasured.

Brief, 30 Oct 2026; Parts 2–4 current decision; AI Evidence Log.

The unit is a person; payment events are diagnostic

Cohort and numerator

N = eligible first-ever-MF investors whose first Groww SIP reached month 12. A = people with ≥1 finally successful SIP instalment in the prior 30 days.

Unknown and bound

N = A + I + U, where I has no confirmed success and U is unresolved. Report A/N and missingness U/N; possible range [A/N, (A+U)/N].

Multiple SIP rule

At checkpoint, active person = OR of qualifying successes across their SIPs. One failed plan or one manual purchase cannot be called an inactive investor.

Product pathway → where Groww might change an outcome

Setup

Mandate + amount/date fit

Due

Wanted payment attempted

Order

Final SIP success, not just debit

Recovery

Unwanted gap repaired safely

Checkpoint

Any SIP succeeds at month 12

If x net additional eligible people qualify: ΔNSM = 100 × x/N percentage points. x and N are unknown; one repaired plan may give x = 0.

Actor cut: investor chooses; Groww explains and routes; bank, mandate/rail, fund and registrar affect execution. Do not assign every failure to Groww.

We investigated contrasting decisions, not just complaints

Question and method

Which *first-year* moment could separate intended continuation from a wanted interruption? Use critical incidents: starting intent → trigger → app/bank signals → action → this-cycle result → following due → other SIPs. Compare a repairer, continuer and informed pauser.

Why these sources?

Public first-person accounts expose mechanisms and workarounds; the discovery engine organizes nine questions. The nine-response written survey screens cohort fit and tests whether the public story appears first-hand. Official help establishes capability, not usage.

Current-flow/competitor check

Groww documents skip, edit, Pay/Pay Now, AutoPay and order-status help. Zerodha Coin documents modify, pause and delete. Therefore “add a pause button” or copy parity is weak. The possible gap is understanding and restoring the *next* scheduled state.

Evidence rule

Code stated reason, supported situation and researcher driver hypothesis separately. One root ≠ one verified first-time Groww investor. No prevalence from selected posts.

Decision rule

Compare user cost, target fit, plausible person-level path, Groww influence, current workaround, harm risk and rival. Keep reach/lift unknown. Reverse the choice if current help or a simpler fix resolves the task.

Nine-question audit; primary survey audit; official Groww and Coin help, checked 9 Nov 2026.

The engine generated leads; source checks changed their meaning

932
review IDs retrieved

100
stored public voice rows

9/9
source-linked question readings

4
unscored opportunity leads

Q1–3 · start and change

Long-term security can coexist with early-profit expectation. Posts describe skip, reduction, manual recovery and intended continuation. “Stop” must be separated from a single missed instalment.

Q4–6 · check and seek help

People report checking returns, order status and mandate routes, then asking peers, bank or Groww support. Frequency and whether outside answers were correct are unknown.

Q7–9 · contrast and need

Concern can coexist with continuation; a skip can precede a paid month. Candidate unmet needs: predictable changes, dependable recovery and understandable status. Silent drop-offs and segment rates remain unseen.

Correction: 932 retrieved IDs ≠ 932 eligible investors; a bank debit ≠ completed SIP; a manual catch-up ≠ restored next AutoPay.

Source-linked readings are research leads. They do not calculate Groww retention, establish a causal root cause or rank opportunity size.

The survey challenges the story, but cannot validate a mechanism

9

form submissions

8

adult + willing

5/8

tried SIP

1/8

broad target fit

Method chosen

A written form was available, so we screened prior MF, first platform and time since SIP. For causal detail, a neutral critical-incident follow-up is needed: what was intended, seen, done and what happened at the next due date.

Observed arithmetic

Eight eligible = 4 completed SIP + 1 setup-only attempt + 3 never attempted. Five attempters = 1 no prior MF + 3 prior MF + 1 unsure. Only one respondent intersects no prior MF, first Groww SIP and 7–12 months.

What changed in our thinking

The broad-fit respondent names long-term security but expected early profits and says a recent payment differed from expectation. There is no incident narrative, final order or following scheduled result. A payment-only interpretation is therefore too narrow.

Research gap, not a result: 0/5–6 interviews; 0 complete strict-cohort incidents; checking frequency and “what would help” were not directly captured.

A volunteer form cannot estimate segment prevalence. Mock interviews would test a script, not validate the opportunity.

Five situations were compared on the same PM criteria

Situation	Evidence and user cost	Metric path / rival
Automation-reliant restorer	Repeated manual investing, bank + Groww contact after a working routine.	Wanted all-plan gap could matter; bank/rail may own fault.
Budget recalibrator	Expense change → skip, pay next month, consider lower amount.	Revised routine could help; informed pause may be correct.
Schedule interpreter	Asks what edit/skip/cancel means for next due date.	Could avoid surprise; existing help may suffice.
Early-return reassessor	Checks negative/low return, yet a writer keeps SIPs going.	Expectation gap; no all-plan loss shown.
Externally guided starter	Friend influenced start; later reconsiders plan.	Ownership of plan unknown; circumstance may explain change.

Working choice: the automation-reliant routine restorer. Why: repeated *reported* work and a concrete next-due uncertainty; not because this is the largest segment.
All five can overlap within one person. Reach, severity distribution, cohort fit and retention effect are unknown; choice is reversible.

The repair burden is real in a public account; its cause is unresolved

After an initially working SIP routine fails, a person who still wants to contribute may pay manually and contact multiple actors yet lack confidence that the following scheduled contribution will work.

Who / when

Provisional first-year automation-reliant restorer; after unwanted due failure, before next due.

What is observed

One writer reports months of manual repair, bank/Groww support and mandate replacement.

Underlying factors

Bank/rail, mandate linkage, order processing, status meaning and support hand-off are rival branches.

Workaround

Manual purchase, support contact, mandate change; none proves the next AutoPay is fixed.

Why solve? Investor: less repair and safer next action. Business: only net additional eligible people with month-12 SIP success move the NSM.

FINAL_PROBLEM_BOUNDARY_2026-11-09.md; current Groww help; public account links in Evidence Log.

The solution narrowed as each piece of evidence ruled something out

Initial thought	Metric correction	User contrast	Primary challenge	Revised bet
Payment failure might equal SIP drop-off.	One failed plan or manual retry does not equal an inactive person.	Same-cycle recovery, deliberate skip and continued SIP contradict one universal cause.	One target-screen answer has expectation tension but no next-payment story.	Help distinguish this order from the following due, without claiming to fix AutoPay.

A · Current help

Official information exists, but the person must join bank debit, SIP order, workaround and next AutoPay across pages.

B · Fixed SIP Check

Six user-chosen facts create a safe two-cycle explanation. It handles known/unknown states without a model; currently live.

C · Gated AI reading

Could translate ambiguous wording into proposed facts, then code checks conflicts and the user corrects them. Held after weak extraction; must beat B safely.

Decision: ship B as the testable baseline; do not claim C adds value until an independent quality and task comparison passes.

Decision history: Part 2–4 recheck; creativity audit; MVP contract. Concept comparison untested.

A customer completes one SIP-status task; AI remains gated

1 · Tell us

Choose a scenario or enter six facts: intent, debit, Groww order, workaround, next due, other SIP.

2 · Understand

See what is confirmed for this payment and what remains unknown for the following scheduled SIP.

3 · Verify

Get a precise question and official Groww help link. Review the entered facts; no account access or investment instruction.

Visible safety gate

Processing is never called complete; one-time/manual payment does not prove next AutoPay; another SIP remains separate; uncertain state routes to official checking. Free text is held when extraction cannot meet quality gate.

What has been tested

148 code tests and a live manual-payment/pause walkthrough passed. Target-segment real tasks: 0/3. Independent ~20-item human golden-set agreement: unrun. These are different kinds of evidence.

AI would earn its place only by interpreting mixed user wording more accurately and safely than the fixed guide on the same task.

Live SIP Check and CONTINUITY_MAP_EVAL.md; no real target-user task study completed.

Measure understanding first; test retention only with a mature cohort

Leading outcomes

Correct known-vs-unknown status / completed tasks; correct official route / tasks; next wanted successful SIP / intended due instalments. Also track whether a changed plan matches stated intent.

Business experiment

Randomize eligible *people*, not SIPs. Track this-cycle and next scheduled results, all-plan status and unresolved U. At month 12 compare A/N and investor-welfare guardrails. No public baseline or lift exists.

Risks and responses

Duplicate-pay advice → no action until order check. Bank fault → actor-neutral support route. Retention pressure → respect informed pause. Bad AI extraction → fallback to fixed check. Selection bias → no prevalence claim.

Prioritisation and reversal

RICE = reach × impact × confidence / effort. Numeric ranking is dishonest here: reach, incremental impact and effort are not measured. Reopen the choice if current help solves the task, strict-fit cases show budget changes dominate, or bank failure persists despite perfect explanation.

Completion boundary: 9 survey submissions; 0/5–6 interviews; 0/3 target-user tests; no independent AI quality result. This is a researched, deployed hypothesis test—not validated retention lift.

Brief; PART2_4_CURRENT_DECISION_2026-11-09.md; AI Evidence Log. Proposed company experiment.